

Waste not, want not

Buying cheap things won't necessarily fatten a savings account. Cheap goods don't last, so while there are parts of your budget that will need a haircut, other areas need only a fringe trim to save money in the long run.

There are ways to get your hands on a stylish wardrobe for much less than retail price. A \$50 pair of jeans that needs to be replaced every season because the seams pop will add up to several hundred dollars over the life of your first home savings plan. However, a \$100 pair should see you through your savings journey – and the frayed look, as the denim takes on a worn-in, destroyed quality, is on trend at the moment.

If you adhere to a savings plan, then occasional necessary spending won't harm your bank balance or your pride. In the early days of pocket money saving, I discovered that when I bought cheaply I bought more often, instead of making a single thoughtful purchase, so my habits had not changed for the better. Michelle Laving says some of her clients excel at cutting back on big expenses – the sort with hefty price tags that trigger guilt, worry and shame – but continue to make many small regular purchases, so their poor financial habits have not improved.

The beauty of receiving pocket money is that you have to plan purchases in advance, and cannot indulge in quick gratification. And, to go back to my fashion roots, this provides an opportunity for a so-called wardrobe edit. At the start of the pocket money journey, I bought a rack for my bedroom on which to hang my most worn, most loved pieces – outfits for work and the weekend, which served me from the desk to dinner and back again. By compartmentalising, I understood I could get by with very little, and sold crates of clothes at markets and on eBay.

These are my must-have pieces that have served me through my pocket money savings journey:

- A black blazer, slim-line and single-breasted
- Two pairs of black trousers: one wide leg, one slender leg